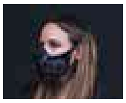

Razer Project Hazel
The Razer mask concept that was revealed at CES 2021 is going into production. **http://dgit.in/apr21-31**

Chainalysis valuation crosses $2B
Thanks to the recent cryptoboom, Chainalysis, a blockchain analysis company, has doubled its valuation. **http://dgit.in/apr21-32**

AMD Radeon RX 6700 XT Graphics Card

Great gen-on-gen upgrade

The AMD Radeon RX 6700 XT would be the first mid-range RDNA 2 card from Team Red but with all launches coming out during the global chip shortage, this too has managed to raise a few eye-brows. The 6700 XT is based on a smaller GPU than the previously released 6900XT, 6800 XT and 6800 and is set to compete with the likes of the NVIDIA RTX 3070 given that it is priced at ₹46,008.

Unlike the 5000-series launch, we aren't seeing multiple mid-range GPUs this time around. One could very well blame the global chip shortage for that. So let's check out the specifications of the only mid-range AMD RDNA 2 graphics card at the moment.

PERFORMANCE

The AMD Radeon RX 6700 XT scores 11,416 in TimeSpy which puts it a little behind the RTX 3070's 12,618. Similarly, in Fire Strike Ultra, the 6700 XT scores a little over 200 points lower than the RTX 3070. The cards are similarly priced in India and the 6700 XT with taxes costs a little more than the RTX 3070. TimeSpy shows a 20 per cent improvement over the 5700 XT and about a 36 per cent improvement in Fire Strike Ultra.

As observed with all the other RDNA 2 cards tested so far, OpenGL performance in Basemark is usually less than half of what the competing cards are capable of. The new RTX 3060 Ti also scores more than the RX 6700 XT. Compared to the 5700 XT, the 6700 XT shows a 30 per cent generational improvement in scores except for OpenGL.

We see the RTX 3070 scoring higher by about 20-25 per cent across 1080p, 1440p and 2160p compared to the RX 6700 XT in Death Stranding. You still get about 68 FPS at 4K resolution which makes it great for playing 4K console ports. In Shadow of the Tomb Raider, we see a 30 per cent improvement in performance over the RX 5700 XT but the RTX 3070 is ahead by 12-18 per cent across all tested resolutions. Coming to Witcher 3, we see the RX 6700 XT scoring about 150 FPS at 1080p which is a 17 per cent improvement over the RX 5700 XT and 25 per cent lower than the RTX 3070. At 1440p, we get a little over 100 FPS and at 4K we're a little shy of 60 FPS.

The Radeon RX 6700 XT ends up being just as capable as the RTX 2070 Super in terms of ray-tracing performance. The RTX 3060 Ti and the RTX 3070 score much higher. In fact, the 3070 provides 40 per cent higher performance in synthetic benchmarks. When it comes to games with ray-tracing, we saw the 6700 XT hit approximately 81 FPS in Metro Exodus at 1080p and the RTX 3070 scored 105 FPS. So the synthetic performance gap narrows down in real-world gaming scenarios.

76

FEATURES........................79
PERFORMANCE...........72
VALUE...............................75
DESIGN............................77

POWER CONSUMPTION

During most of our gaming benchmarks, we saw the RX 6700 XT hit a peak of 84 degrees celsius. During overclocking with the power limits removed, this would go up to 86 degrees. The junction temperature would easily hit 106 degrees under the same conditions but for the most part, we averaged around 76 degrees celsius. Peak power consumption levels during the benchmarks was 186 watts as reported by the Radeon Software. During our OC attempts, we saw the power draw hit about 213 watts peak.

VERDICT

The Radeon RX 6700 XT is a decent card with the pricing being a little off. Considering its Indian pricing, it's a direct competitor to the RTX 3070 and it falls short in practically all of the benchmarks that we ran it through. However, considering that it's the generational upgrade over the RDNA 1 Radeon RX 5700 XT, we see significant performance gains that actually make it a great buy. Add the fact that you also have ray-tracing capabilities and this becomes even more impressive. All of this doesn't matter if you can't buy the card in India.

–Mithun Mohandas

SPECIFICATIONS
STREAM PROCESSORS: 2560 | CU: 40 | BOOST CLOCK: 2581 MHz | VRAM: 12 GB GDDR6 | BUS-WIDTH: 192-bit | CONNECTORS: 1x 8-PIN + 1x 6-PIN | TBP: 230W

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